SpeedUP

English Course

Vocabulary: Holidays & Culture

Holiday	feriado / férias	*“New Year's Day is a national holiday.”*
Festival	festival	*“The music festival happens every summer.”*
Celebrate	celebrar / comemorar	*“We celebrate Christmas with family.”*
Tradition	tradição	*“It’s a tradition to eat turkey on Thanksgiving.”*
Culture	cultura	*“Brazilian culture is very rich.”*
Custom	costume / hábito cultural	*“It’s a custom to bow in Japan.”*
Special	especial	*“This is a special day for our family.”*
Ceremony	cerimônia	*“The graduation ceremony is on Friday.”*

Talking About What People Always Do

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Use the Present Simple to describe cultural habits, traditions, and things that happen regularly.

Model Sentences

- "Brazilians celebrate Carnival every year."
- "People wear costumes on Halloween."
- "Families eat special food on holidays."
- "The ceremony usually takes place at night."
- "Many cultures celebrate the new year with fireworks."

Structure	Example
People + verb	"People celebrate with music and food."
Subject + always/usually + verb	"Families usually gather at Christmas."
Subject + do/does not + verb	"Some people don't celebrate this holiday."

"In [Country], we/they..."

Use this structure to compare how different countries celebrate or do things.

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In [country], we/they + verb...
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Examples

- "**In Brazil**, we celebrate Carnival with samba."
- "**In the USA**, they celebrate Thanksgiving in November."
- "**In Japan**, they have the Cherry Blossom Festival."
- "**In Mexico**, they celebrate Día de los Muertos."
- "**In Australia**, Christmas is in summer."

Useful Contrast Connector

- "**In Brazil**, we eat rice and beans. **In Japan**, they eat rice and fish."
- "**In the USA**, they give presents at Christmas. **In Brazil**, we also give presents."

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"In Brazil, we eat rice and beans.
↔️ In Japan, they eat rice and fish."

"In the USA, they give presents at Christmas.
↔️ In Brazil, we also give presents."

Common Ways to Talk About Culture

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More Examples

- "It's a tradition to light candles during Hanukkah."
- "We always watch the parade on national holidays."
- "It's common to send greeting cards on special occasions."
- "People usually wear white at New Year's in Brazil."

Expression	Example
It's a tradition to...	"It's a tradition to wear new clothes on New Year's."
We always...	"We always eat together on Christmas."
People usually...	"People usually watch fireworks on New Year's Eve."
It's common to...	"It's common to give flowers at weddings."
It's important to...	"It's important to respect other cultures."

Short Text

Maria is from Brazil and her friend Anna is from the USA. They talk about how their countries celebrate the new year. Maria says: "In Brazil, we usually wear white and go to the beach. We eat lentils because it's a tradition for good luck." Anna says: "In the USA, people watch fireworks and celebrate with family. It's common to make new year resolutions." Both girls agree: every culture has special customs, and it's important to respect and learn about them.

Language Highlights

- In Brazil, we usually wear white
- it's a tradition for good luck
- In the USA, people watch fireworks
- It's common to make resolutions
- every culture has special customs
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